MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

Infrastructure & DevOps | CI/CD | Kubernetes

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Infrastructure-focused QA Automation Engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two years focused largely on CI/CD ownership, Kubernetes-based test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral test environments for three product teams. Experienced with Docker, Helm, Kubernetes at namespace level, Python and Bash, with personal hands-on practice in k3s, GitOps and Terraform. Seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access), k3s, Argo CD

Infrastructure as Code and automation: Terraform (personal projects), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python

Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Other: Linux, Git, AWS (EC2 and S3 fundamentals; self-directed learning), Java (test code)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw
2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering builds, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster, including application services, PostgreSQL and seeded data. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to under 1%.
- Developed Python tooling to collect CI test results into PostgreSQL and Grafana dashboards that helped teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Authored an internal guide to the CI system, used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices; deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation in progress; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)